

DAY 13

Change Request Management

Learning Objectives:

- Understand why change requests exist and what problem they solve
- Learn the Change Control Process: how a request is raised, reviewed, approved, and implemented
- Understand the impact of scope creep and how Change Requests prevent it
- Learn how to write a formal Change Request document
- **YouTube Search Terms:**
 - "Change request process project management"
 - "Scope creep explained project management"
 - "Change control board CCB"
 - "How to handle change requests in agile"
- **Recommended Channels:**
 - [ProjectManager.com](https://www.projectmanager.com)
 - Google Project Management Certificate
 - PMC Lounge

Tasks:

- Study scope creep — understand how it starts (a small request, informally agreed), why it is damaging (unplanned work, delayed timelines, team overload), and how a formal Change Request process prevents it
- Learn the Change Control Process in sequence — Request Raised → Impact Assessment (time, cost, scope, risk) → Review by Change Control Board → Decision (Approved/Rejected/Deferred) → Implementation → Documentation update
- Write a Change Request form template that covers CR ID, Date, Requestor, Description of Change, Business Justification, Impact on Scope, Impact on Timeline, Impact on Cost, Impact on Risk, PM Recommendation, Decision, and Sign-off
- Write 3 complete Change Request documents for realistic scenarios on the Expense Tracker project — adding a new currency converter feature mid-project, changing the delivery date by 2 weeks, and reducing the budget by 20%

Deliverable

- Change Request form template
- 3 completed Change Request documents
- Short note: the difference between a Change Request in Waterfall vs how scope changes are handled in Agile

Scope Creep

Scope creep occurs when additional features or requirements are added without proper approval or planning. It usually starts with small informal requests such as "Can we add one more feature?" Over time, these changes increase workload, delay timelines, raise costs, and overload the team.

A formal Change Request process prevents scope creep by ensuring every change is documented, assessed for impact, reviewed, approved, and tracked before implementation.

Change Control Process:

The Change Control Process follows a structured sequence to manage project changes effectively:

1. **Request Raised** - A change request is submitted.
2. **Impact Assessment** - The project team evaluates the impact on time, cost, scope, and risk.
3. **Review by Change Control Board (CCB)** - The request is reviewed by stakeholders or the CCB.
4. **Decision** - The request is either Approved, Rejected, or Deferred.
5. **Implementation** - If approved, the change is implemented in the project.
6. **Documentation Update** - Project plans, schedules, and related documents are updated to reflect the change.

Change Control Board (CCB) is a group of stakeholders responsible for reviewing and making decisions on project change requests.

Responsibilities of the CCB:

- Review submitted change requests.
- Assess the impact on scope, time, cost, and risk.
- Decide whether the change should be **Approved, Rejected, or Deferred**.
- Ensure only beneficial and justified changes are implemented.

Example:

If the Product Owner requests a new Currency Converter feature for the Expense Tracker project, the CCB evaluates its impact on budget, timeline, and project scope before approving or rejecting the request.

Change Request Form Template

Field	Details
Change Request ID	CR-XXX
Date Submitted	DD/MM/YYYY
Requestor	Name
Project Name	Expense Tracker Application
Description of Change	Detailed explanation of requested change
Business Justification	Reason and expected benefit
Impact on Scope	Features/tasks added, removed, or modified
Impact on Timeline	Schedule impact
Impact on Cost	Additional or reduced budget
Impact on Risk	New risks introduced
PM Recommendation	Approve / Reject / Defer with comments
CCB Decision	Approved / Rejected / Deferred
Approved By	Change Control Board
Sign-off Date	DD/MM/YYYY

Change Request 1

Add Currency Converter Feature

Field	Details
Change Request ID	CR-001
Date Submitted	18/06/2026
Requestor	Product Owner
Project Name	Expense Tracker Application
Description of Change	Add a currency converter feature allowing users to view expenses in multiple currencies using live exchange rates
Business Justification	Many users travel internationally and need expense reports in different currencies.
Impact on Scope	New Currency Converter module API integration for exchange rates Additional UI screens Additional testing
Impact on Timeline	Estimated increase of 1 week.
Impact on Cost	Additional ₹50,000 for development and API integration.
Impact on Risk	Dependency on third-party API Potential API downtime
PM Recommendation	Approve because it adds significant business value.
CCB Decision	Approved
Approved By	Change Control Board
Sign-off Date	20/06/2026

Change Request 2

Extend Delivery Date by 2 Weeks

Field	Details
Change Request ID	CR-002
Date Submitted	21/06/2026
Requestor	Project Sponsor
Project Name	Expense Tracker Application
Description of Change	Extend the final delivery date by two weeks to allow additional testing and bug fixing.
Business Justification	Improved product quality before release.
Impact on Scope	No change in scope.
Impact on Timeline	Project completion moves from 15 August 2026 to 29 August 2026.
Impact on Cost	Additional ₹30,000 due to extended team allocation.
Impact on Risk	Reduced risk of production defects.
PM Recommendation	Approve because quality improvement outweighs schedule extension.
CCB Decision	Approved
Approved By	Change Control Board
Sign-off Date	21/06/2026

Change Request 3

Reduce Project Budget by 20%

Field	Details
Change Request ID	CR-003
Date Submitted	24/06/2026
Requestor	Finance Department
Project Name	Expense Tracker Application
Description of Change	Reduce the approved project budget by 20%.
Business Justification	Organization-wide cost reduction initiative.
Impact on Scope	Some low-priority enhancements may need to be removed.
Impact on Timeline	Possible delay of 1 week due to reduced resources.
Impact on Cost	Budget reduced from ₹5,00,000 to ₹4,00,000.
Impact on Risk	Reduced development capacity, increased delivery risk, and lower flexibility for future changes.
PM Recommendation	Approve with scope reduction to maintain quality.
CCB Decision	Deferred for further review.
Approved By	Pending
Sign-off Date	Pending

Change Request in Waterfall vs Agile

Waterfall	Agile
Change Requests are formal and heavily documented.	Changes are expected and handled through backlog refinement and sprint planning.
Every change goes through a strict approval process.	Product Owner prioritizes changes in the backlog.
Changes after requirements freeze are expensive.	Changes can be added in future sprints with less disruption.
Focus is on controlling scope and preventing deviations.	Focus is on adapting to customer needs while maintaining sprint goals.
Change Control Board (CCB) often approves major changes.	Team and Product Owner usually manage scope adjustments.